{EPITECH}

PRODUCT DESIGN_

< FROM USER NEEDS TO MVP />

PRODUCT DESIGN

Context

Social platforms evolve quickly as users seek more focused and meaningful interactions. Smaller, targeted communities regularly challenge established actors by offering simpler, more engaging or more privacy-conscious experiences.

Your team has been commissioned to imagine, design and develop a new social web application. The objective is not to compete with major platforms, but to explore how a well-designed product can address a clearly defined user problem within a constrained development scope.

You will operate as a product team: analysing needs, defining a concept, designing the experience, prototyping, testing with peers, and finally delivering a minimal web-based MVP.
The purpose of this project is to demonstrate a professional product design process supported by a functional prototype, not to produce a full application.

Objectives

You will design and develop a social web application allowing users to publish and interact with short content (text, links, or other lightweight formats).

The project is divided into two phases:

1. Product Design
2. MVP Development

The majority of the work is expected during the Product Design phase.
The MVP is a demonstration of the key user flow of your concept.

All deliverables — including Product Design documents — must be committed and organized within the same GitHub repository as the MVP.

Structure of the Repository

Your repository must follow this structure:

```
.
|-- docs/
|    |-- 01_research/
|    |-- 02_personas/
|    |-- 03_user_journey/
|    |-- 04_wireframes/
|    |-- 05_mockups/
|    |-- 06_prototype/
|    |-- 07_feedback/
|    |-- 08_prioritization/
|    |-- 09_pitch/
|-- mvp/
|-- <source code of the web application>
```

> ⚠ Each folder must contain a clear `README.md` explaining its content.

Phase 1 — Product Design

1. Research and Problem Framing

Expected deliverables (inside `/docs/01_research/`):

- ✓ `benchmark.md`
  Analysis of similar or related solutions and identification of differentiating points.
- ✓ `interviews.md`
  Notes from discussions with classmates (minimum 3 structured interviews).
  Content must highlight needs, frustrations, habits or expectations.
- ✓ `problem_statement.md`
  A concise formulation of the problem your product addresses.
- ✓ `objectives_constraints.md`
  List of measurable objectives, assumptions, risks and constraints.

All insights must be factual, even if based on a limited user sample.

2. Personas and User Journey

Expected deliverables:

`/docs/02_personas/`

- ✓ `persona_*.md`
  At least one persona, with goals, motivations, behaviours and pain points.

`/docs/03_user_journey/`

- ✓ `user_journey.md`
  A description of the main usage scenario, step by step, including friction points and opportunities.

Personas and journeys must be derived from your research.

3. UX Design

Expected deliverables:

`/docs/04_wireframes/`

- ✓ Low-fidelity wireframes of all main screens (PDF, PNG or Figma export).

`/docs/05_mockups/`

- ✓ High-fidelity mockups (at least three screens) with a short justification for key design choices.
- ✓ Explanation of accessibility decisions.

`/docs/06_prototype/`

- ✓ A link to a clickable prototype (Figma or equivalent).
- ✓ A short description of the supported interactions.

The prototype must show the intended experience before development.

4. Feedback and Prioritization

Expected deliverables:

/docs/07_feedback/

- ✓ `test_protocol.md`
  Brief description of what you asked testers to do on the prototype.
- ✓ `feedback_summary.md`
  Consolidated notes from 3 to 5 testers (classmates).
  Highlight recurring issues, confusions or opportunities.

/docs/08_prioritization/

- ✓ `prioritization_matrix.md`
  A matrix (MoSCoW, RICE or other) justifying your choices.
- ✓ `mvp_definition.md`
  A precise description of the MVP scope:
  - main user flow
  - essential screens
  - minimal features
  - what is explicitly excluded

This document defines what will be developed in Phase 2.

5. Product Pitch

Expected deliverables (inside `/docs/09_pitch/`):

- ✓ `pitch_deck.pdf`
  A concise presentation including:
  - problem
  - target users
  - concept
  - UX walkthrough
  - MVP scope

The pitch is used during the final defense.

Phase 2 — MVP Development

You will implement a minimal version of your social application as a web application.
The goal is to demonstrate the essential user flow and validate the core idea through a working interface.

Technical Expectations

- ✓ Technologies are free, but choices must be justified in the main README.
- ✓ The front end must be a web application.
- ✓ The MVP must include a functional main user flow.
- ✓ Authentication is optional.
- ✓ Code must be clean, documented and deployed.
- ✓ A clear installation and usage guide is required.

Examples of acceptable MVP scopes:

- ✓ Create an account, publish a short post, view a feed
- ✓ Publish messages in a small group

- ✓ React to content
- ✓ Follow topics or tags

A narrow, well-executed scope is preferred over a broad but incomplete solution.

Repository Requirements

At the root of your repository:

- ✓ `README.md`
  Must include:
  - overview of the project
  - installation and run instructions
  - deployment instructions
  - justification of technical choices
  - link to prototype
  - description of the `/docs/` structure
- ✓ `/docs/`
  Contains all Product Design deliverables.
- ✓ `/mvp/`
  Contains the source code of the implemented minimal product.
- ✓ A release tag corresponding to the delivered MVP.

Final Defense

You will present:

1. The analysed problem and target users
2. The design process (wireframes, mockups, prototype)
3. The insights from peer testing and their impact on decisions
4. A demonstration of the MVP user flow

You must be able to justify all major design and technical decisions.

Evaluation

Your work will be evaluated on:

- ✓ Quality and clarity of the research and problem framing
- ✓ Coherence and justification of UX and design choices
- ✓ Quality of the prototype and its testability
- ✓ Relevance of prioritization and MVP definition
- ✓ Functionality and reliability of the MVP
- ✓ Structure and clarity of the repository
- ✓ Quality of the pitch and oral defense

The Product Design phase has greater weight in the evaluation.

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